

A lone polar bear surveys the sea for prey from a piece of floating ice in the Arctic. The shrinking area of sea ice in the region threatens this species' survival.

Food size

One of Elton's most important points was the notion that food chains exist primarily because of the principle of food size. He explained that every carnivorous animal eats prey between upper and lower limits. Predators are physically unable to catch and consume other animals above a certain size because they are not large enough, strong enough, or skillful enough. That